

Vijayshree Jayaraman

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Education

PhD Economics, University of Illinois - Urbana-Champaign, Illinois Present.

M.A. Economics, Azim Premji University, Bengaluru 2022 – 2024.

B.A. (Hons) Economics, Minor in Education, Azim Premji University, Bengaluru 2019 – 2022.

Employment

Center for Advanced Financial Research and Learning, Mumbai June 2024 – May 2026.
Research Associate. Supervisor: Dr. Vidhya Soundararajan.

Frontline Impact Jan 2023 – Dec 2023.
Research Associate Consultant (Remote). Supervisor: Dr. Kabira Namit Kapoor, (The World Bank ; University of Oxford).

Azim Premji Foundation, Bengaluru Aug 2022 – Nov 2022.
Student Research Assistant.

Publications and Writing

WORKING PAPERS

1. Jayaraman, V. (2023). [The Unhappy Marriage of Women's Work and Spousal Violence in India](#). *Center for Sustainable Employment*.
Presented at OP Jindal Undergraduate Research Conference (2022).
2. Jayaraman, V. (2025). [Is Gender Parity Costly? Evidence from Rural Local Body Elections](#).
Examines the causal effect of electing female Gram Panchayat presidents on public employment provision in Tamil Nadu, India
Under review at Journal of Development Economics.

OTHER WRITING

1. Jayaraman, V. and D'Costa, C. (2024). Looking for Love in Gary Becker. Presented at International Conference on History of Economic Thought.
2. Jayaraman, V. (2023). [The Nobel in economics as a need to course correct](#). *The Hindu*. November 16.

3. Jayaraman, V. and Moharir, A. (2024). [Funding freeze brings MGNREGS to a standstill in West Bengal](#). *The Hindu*. October 31.
4. Soundararajan, V. and Jayaraman, V. (2025). [It's time for a holistic strategy to foster women's entrepreneurship](#). *Mint*. July 22.
5. Soundararajan, V. et al. (2026). [Financialisation of Indian households: Trends in savings and borrowing](#). *Ideas for India*. May 26.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

1. Teaching an Economic Model of Segregation: Evidence, Best Responses, an In-Class Activity, and a Critical Reflection, with *Simon Halliday* (Johns Hopkins University) and *Priyanshi Tripathi*.
2. Does Caste Network Precede Migration for Indentured Labour? Evidence from South Africa, with *Tamoghna Halder* (Azim Premji University).
3. Door Step Banking and Women's Banking with *Vidhya Soundararajan* (CAFRAL), *Pulak Ghosh* (IIM Bangalore) and *Ankit Kalda* (Kelley School of Business)

Skills

Stata, R, Python, LaTeX

Data Analysis & Typesetting

KoboToolbox, SurveyCTO, Tableau, Google Looker

Survey & Visualization

English, Tamil (native), Hindi

Languages

Manage Successful Field Research (DIME, World Bank, 2023)

Certifications

References

Anand Shrivastava

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Deepti Goel

Pitzer College, California.
Email: deepti_goel@pitzer.edu

Tamoghna Halder

Assistant Professor, Azim Premji University.
Email: tamoghna.halder@apu.edu.in

Vidhya Soundararajan

Assistant Professor, Center for Advanced Financial Research and Learning, Mumbai.
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